

Dexter Williams

PHD STUDENT · INFORMATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison, Morgridge Hall, 1205 University Avenue, Madison, WI 53706

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Education

University of Wisconsin-Madison

PHD IN INFORMATION

- Advisor: Professor Jodi Schneider.
- Research Interests: Argument Mining, Computational Argumentation, AI and Law.
- 4.0 GPA

Madison, Wisconsin

Aug. 2025 - Present

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

PHD IN INFORMATICS

- Advisor: Professor Jodi Schneider.
- 4.0 GPA

Champaign, Illinois

Aug. 2024 - July 2025

University of St Andrews

BSC IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND PHILOSOPHY (JOINT HONOURS)

- First Class (3.9 GPA).

St Andrews, United Kingdom

Sep. 2018 - May 2022

Research Experience

Project Assistant: University of Wisconsin-Madison

SUPERVISOR: PROFESSOR JODI SCHNEIDER

- Support for a Second Edition of the Argumentation Mining monograph.

Madison, WI

2025-Present

Research Intern: Boise State University

SUPERVISOR: PROFESSOR CASEY KENNINGTON

- 3 weeks to learn about Retico: an incremental, real-time spoken dialogue system framework, and to develop modules and a working system.

Boise, ID

2025

Research Assistant: University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

SUPERVISOR: PROFESSOR JODI SCHNEIDER

- Support for a Second Edition of the Argumentation Mining monograph.
- Funded by the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign Campus Research Board, \$14,714

Champaign, IL

2025

Research Assistant: University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

SUPERVISOR: PROFESSOR BERTRAM LUDÄSCHER

- XAI-CA: explainable AI via computational argumentation.
- Funded by the 2025 Cardiff University-University of Illinois System Joint Research and Innovation Seed Grants Program.

Champaign, IL

2025

Undergraduate Research Assistant: University of St Andrews

SUPERVISOR: PROFESSOR IAN GENT

- Generic explanations for pen and paper puzzles with MUSes.

St Andrews, Scotland, UK

2020

Undergraduate Research Assistant: University of St Andrews

SUPERVISOR: DR. KASIM TERZIĆ

- Automated counting of seals in aerial surveys.

St Andrews, Scotland, UK

2019-2020

Professional Experience

2022-2024 **Software Engineer/Consultant**, Capgemini Engineering

2021 **Data Science Intern**, NHS Digital

Teaching Experience _____

2024-2025 **Analytical Foundations for Information Problems**, Teaching Assistant

UIUC

Publications _____

CONFERENCE PAPERS

Dexter Williams. That Feels Convincing: Assessing the Quality of Pathotic Arguments. *Argumentation in the Digital Society*. Proceedings of the 5th European Conference on Argumentation (ECA 2025). In review.

Dexter Williams. Decorum in the Forum: Emotional Interactions in U.S. Presidential Press Conferences. *Arguing Democracy*. Proceedings of the 2025 NCA/AFA argumentation conference (Alta). Forthcoming from Taylor & Francis.

Heng Zheng, **Dexter Williams**, Bertram Ludäscher (2025). Using LLMs to Model Arguments in U.S. Supreme Court Briefs: Preliminary Report. *International Workshop on Translating Natural Legal Language into Formal Representation (NLL2FR 2025)* at the *Thirty-eighth International Conference on Legal Knowledge and Information Systems (JURIX 2025)*.

POSTERS

Heng Zheng, **Dexter Williams**, Bertram Ludäscher (2025). Modeling U.S. Supreme Court Briefs with Computational Argumentation. *Thirty-eighth International Conference on Legal Knowledge and Information Systems (JURIX 2025)*.

Dexter Williams (2024). Assessing the Quality of Pathotic Arguments. *2024 iSchool Research Showcase at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign*.

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants _____

2025	iSchool Conference Presentation Award , University of Wisconsin-Madison	\$ 1,612
2025	Informatics Conference Presentation Award , University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	\$ 1,000
2024	Informatics Recruitment Fellowship , University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	\$ 30,000
2018-2022	Dean's List , University of St Andrews	

Mentoring _____

2025-2026	Undergraduate Independent Study , Supervisor, University of Wisconsin-Madison
2021	St Andrews Mentoring Initiative , Mentor, University of St Andrews
2020	Coronavirus Tutoring Initiative , Tutor

Service _____

PEER REVIEWER

15th edition of the Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (LREC 2026)

The 13th Workshop on Argument Mining (ArgMining 2026)

The 12th Workshop on Argument Mining (ArgMining 2025)

DEVELOPMENT

European Conference on Argumentation 2025 Summer School